

Space Age

Which is the best telescope to gaze into the night sky? We tell you that and more...

**"Installous" shuts down**

The pirated app store called "Installous", which provided pirated copies of paid apps for iOS shut down recently.

The Internet Of Things

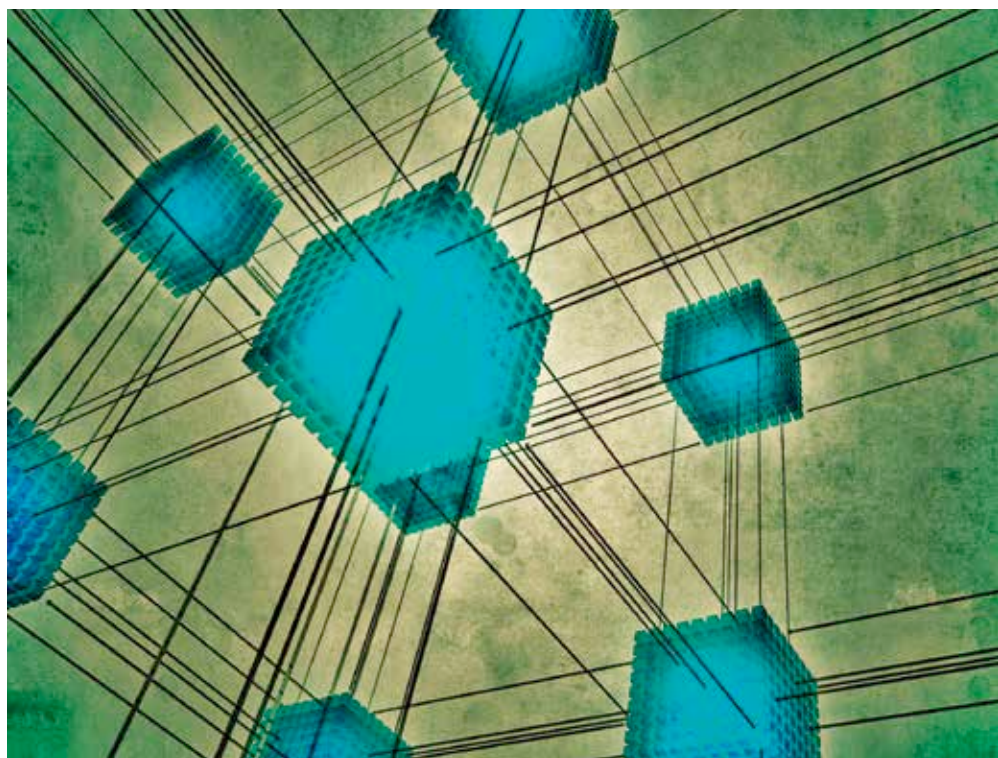
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The era of smart, connected devices is well and truly upon us

The Internet has revolutionized our lives in more ways than we care to imagine. Within a decade from being a desirable facet of one's life, the Internet has invaded our homes and is now a strong necessity that we can't live without. Yet what we deem as the Internet is just a web of computers (in one shape or another) exchanging data through a network of communication devices (routers, switches, etc.). These days the definition of computers has changed a bit to encompass highly evolved gadgets like smartphones and tablets that access the Internet more than good old PCs ever did. Often what we loosely label as the Internet (for checking Facebook, reading websites, etc.) is in fact the World Wide Web or Web – just a means of reading content over the Internet's superhighway. This is where most of us restrict our involvement of the Internet. To think we call this minor obsession of ours with the Internet a revolution is just plain ridiculous.

Imagine an Internet of intelligent devices (not PCs) that requires minimum supervision, as a separate network entity which interacts with the Internet, leveraging its potential different to what we are used to in our-day-to-day life. The possibilities of such an Internet, alive with gadgets and devices, is vastly more enriching. Just thinking about it is enough to realize that such an Internet of Things will go a long way in making our lives more comfortable than they already are. And it may be unfolding around us in the coming months.

**The next big wave**

Internet of Things has been a buzzword on the technology horizon for the past couple of years. But not until the Consumer Electronics Show held in January this year did the term re-surface and claw back into popular discourse. There were products unveiled at the year's biggest technology show to signal that the Internet of Things has matured far beyond a concept to buzzing, beeping devices produced by a variety of manufacturers, lending much-needed momentum to the phenomenon's widespread acceptance.

Fancy an electronic, remotely operated light switch to your living room? Check out the Belkin WeMo Light Switch which looks and feels like any ordinary light switch, only it's not – it's much smarter, connects to Wi-Fi and can be remotely controlled from anywhere in the world by an iOS (and soon-to-release Android) app. Can't check on your flower garden regularly when you're busy travelling? Monitor their well-being through this ingenious Parrot Flower Power sensor asasasas The device plugs into the soil to track sunlight, moisture, temperature and